Notes made to prepare for interviews

Aladdin Studio from the outside

What public sources show, and one direction they point to. Through Studio, clients' own AI tools could use the tools Copilot uses, acting for each user under that user's Aladdin permissions.

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Independent analysis of public sources, done with AI agents. Not produced, reviewed or endorsed by BlackRock.

Executive summary

Through Studio, clients' own AI tools could use the tools Copilot uses, acting for each user under that user's Aladdin permissions.

Studio is Aladdin's developer and data layer: APIs and events, Aladdin Data Cloud, and developer tools[1]. Many data providers now let outside AI tools read their data[2, 3, 4, 5]. Aladdin's APIs can also post orders and assign compliance rules to portfolios. Each API has its own OAuth scopes, and most mark each scope as read or write. Posting an order runs a compliance check by default[6]. An AI tool calling these APIs would work under the same API controls as any other client program.

Rivals have begun letting AI agents act. Arcesium's MCP server lets outside AI tools build data pipelines[7]. Clearwater says clients use its agents for trade settlement and cash management[8]. BlackRock already runs AI on Aladdin. Copilot answers questions for staff and clients in about 100 Aladdin applications. It draws on about two thousand registered tools and agents, and each tool maps to an Aladdin API already in production[9]. No public source shows Copilot posting orders. Buyers of investment software say AI is changing what they build[10]. BlackRock estimated that API calls across BlackRock and Aladdin would grow 17x by 2030[11]. Part 3 sets out this direction, what would have to be true for it to hold, and four pieces of marketing work that would follow.

Limitations of methodology

Public material only: BlackRock web pages, its 54 public API specifications, about 125 recordings, SEC filings, procurement notices, GitHub and PyPI. AI agents gathered them. I checked every fact against its document. Some recordings are machine-transcribed, so names and jargon can be misheard. I have no internal product context, so some conclusions may be wrong.

Part 1

What the public record shows

Aladdin is the investment platform BlackRock built for itself and sells to other institutions. Brennan Rosales, an AI Engineering Lead at BlackRock, put the scale this way in 2025. "BlackRock is the biggest user of Aladdin, but we also sell and support hundreds of clients globally across 70 countries." It maintains "around 100 Aladdin front-end applications"[9]. BlackRock's technology services and subscription revenue was $2.0 billion in 2025[12]. Its 24 percent rise includes Preqin, the private-markets data firm BlackRock bought in 2025[12]. Annual contract value grew 16 percent excluding Preqin[12]. BlackRock sells Aladdin as four platforms: the Aladdin platform, eFront, Aladdin Wealth and Preqin[13]. Exhibit 1 lists eight products sold across them. Studio is the entry point for people who write code[14].

What BlackRock sells

Exhibit 1. Of eight Aladdin products shown, Studio is the one for people who write code

Product	What it does
Aladdin	The front-to-back system for public and private markets[15], the same one BlackRock runs internally[9]
Aladdin Wealth	Risk analysis and proposals for advisors[16]
eFront	A private-fund platform that now includes Preqin[17]
Aladdin Studio	**The developer and data layer: APIs and events, Data Cloud, developer tools[1].** For engineers, data analysts and code-curious portfolio managers[14]
Aladdin Data Cloud	Managed data on Snowflake[18], and part of Studio[19]
Aladdin Copilot	A chat assistant available to all Aladdin clients[20]
Aladdin Accounting	Investment accounting and performance[21], with public APIs for valuations, lots and composites[6]
Aladdin Provider	Gives custodians and administrators access to Aladdin[22]

BlackRock lists nine solutions[14]. ■ Source: BlackRock product pages[14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 20, 21]; Rosales and Valdez[9]; Newman[19]; Woodhead[1]; iShares prospectus[22]; the public specifications[6].

Exhibit 2 follows one trade through Aladdin as far as the 54 public specifications describe it[6, 23].

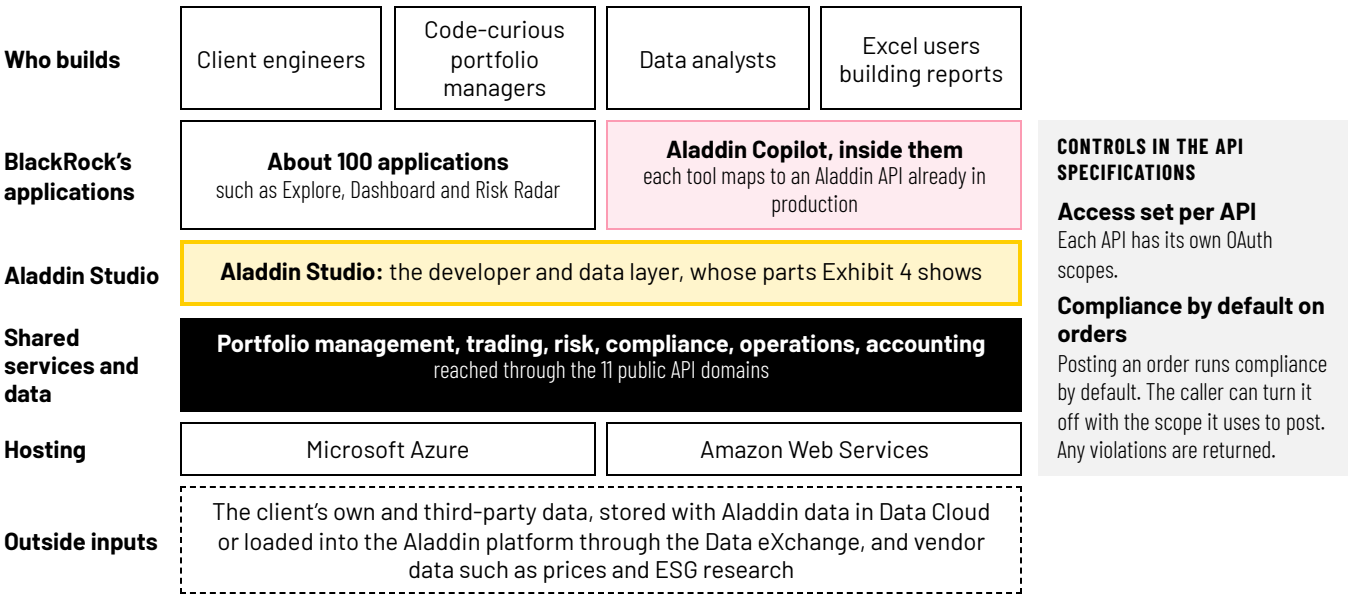
Exhibit 2. The public APIs post orders and trades, and read lots and valuations. None reads portfolio holdings.

	1 Order	2 Compliance check	3 Trade	4 Position in the IBOR	5 Lot in the ABOR	6 NAV
Who	Portfolio manager	Runs automatically. The owner of each violation resolves it.	Trading desk, then operations	Portfolio management, trading, operations[10]	Accounting team[23]	Accounting[23]
Where	Order Monitor in Aladdin Dashboard[6]	Aladdin Compliance[6]	–	Read from Data Cloud, which carries IBOR holdings[19, 24]	Aladdin Accounting[6]	Aladdin Accounting
API	`OrderAPI` v1 (stable)	`OrderAPI` (`runCompliance`), then `ViolationAPI` to resolve	`TradeAPI` v2 (alpha)	**None of the 54 is a position API**	`AborLotAPI` v1 (alpha)	`ValuationsAPI` v1 (beta)
Detail	Test (`whatIf`) and compliance (`runCompliance`)[6]	`runCompliance` is on by default[6]		No holdings API[6]		

The public specifications cover the trade but hold no position API. No public specification covers business events. The specifications do not say in what sequence steps 4 to 6 happen.

The labels in brackets are stability labels. Exhibit 5 counts them. ■ Source: the specifications named in each step[6]; the Build vs. Buy webinar[10]; Newman[19]; the Aladdin Accounting episode[23]; Fivetran[24].

Exhibit 3. Where Studio sits in Aladdin



For illustrative purposes only. Every box is named in the sources below. The 11 domains are the packages of BlackRock's public software development kit (SDK). The specifications also name Dashboard and Risk Radar. Controls as in Exhibit 13. ■ Source: Rosales, for the apps and Copilot[9]; a training recording, for Explore[25]; Woodhead, for Studio[1]; the public specifications and SDK[6, 26]; BlackRock's Studio, APIs, ATX, ADX, Data Cloud and Aladdin Risk pages[14, 18, 27, 28, 29, 30]; the Data Cloud launch release[31]; the FY2025 10-K, for hosting[12]; Microsoft, for Azure[32]; data vendors, ICE and Sustainalytics[33, 34].

Exhibit 4. What Studio is made of

WHAT STUDIO OFFERS

APIs Read and write Aladdin data. Built on Aladdin Graph, BlackRock's production runtime for APIs and events	**Event-driven workflows** Aladdin tells a program when something happens. No public specification covers business events	**Aladdin SDK** Open-source Python library. The public SDK has typed clients for the APIs and a Snowflake connection for Data Cloud
Aladdin Data Cloud A managed data store on Snowflake	**Aladdin Compute** Hosted, ready-to-use Python environments	**Aladdin Tools for Excel (ATX)** An Excel plugin that pulls Aladdin data into custom reports and analyses
Aladdin Data eXchange (ADX) Bulk file transfer to and from Aladdin	**Developer guides and Data Dictionary** Developer guides, Jupyter notebooks, code samples, and a Data Dictionary of Aladdin field definitions, as listed on the APIs page[27]. The developer portal sits behind a client login[35].	**Governance** Includes "access management and usage monitoring"

INSIDE A CLIENT'S STUDIO WORKSPACE, AS THE PUBLIC SDK'S README AND THE SPECIFICATIONS NAME IT

Studio UI The screens where tokens, applications and storage are set up	**Projects** Personal or shared, each holding OAuth applications and storage
API tokens and OAuth applications Sign-in for the APIs	**Studio Compute sessions** Where Aladdin Compute runs SDK code
S3 storage integration File storage for SDK code, set up in a Project	**Studio notifications** Alerts sent through Studio's notification APIs
ADC Admin Center The screen for managing Data Cloud datasets	**Spaces** Named alongside Projects. Not described publicly.

Source: BlackRock's Studio page[14]; its APIs, ATX and ADX pages, which list Data Cloud, ADX, Aladdin Compute and ATX as "Additional Aladdin Studio resources"[27, 29, 30]; the 54 public specifications[6], for the portal link and the Admin Center; the public SDK's README[26], for the SDK and the other workspace items; Naik and Kalish[36] and the Aladdin Graph job posting[37], for Aladdin Graph; Woodhead[1], Goel[38], the Aladdin Risk page[28] and a BlackRock job posting[39], for events and the portal; the Data Cloud page, for Data Cloud[18]; Snowflake's partner page, for Compute[40]; the developer portal[35]; Studio for Aladdin Risk, for access management[41]. The public SDK uses both names, Aladdin Compute and Studio Compute, for the same hosted environment.

Exhibit 5. The 54 public specifications hold 301 operations, including orders, trades and compliance rules

Domain	Specs	Operations	Alpha	Beta	Stable	Sunset	Largest APIs by operations
Investment operations	15	**74**	9	4	2	–	PrincipalInterestFactor, CounterPartySettlementInstruction, MiscellaneousCashflow, CouponReset and 11 more
Analytics	9	**53**	–	–	8	1	RiskRule, RiskWorkflow, RiskException, RiskConfig and 5 more
Investment research	5	**41**	5	–	–	–	AnalystCoverage, Criterion, Watchlist, ResearchNote and 1 more
Platform	6	**29**	2	–	4	–	AdcDataset, UserGroup, User, UserGroupPermission and 2 more
Portfolio management	4	**28**	1	–	3	–	CIDWriter, Strategy, CIDReader, CashLadder
Portfolio	3	**23**	1	–	2	–	PortfolioGroup, RestrictedAsset, PortfolioToolkit
Data	1	**15**	–	–	1	–	SecurityCreation
Trading	2	**14**	1	–	1	–	Order, Trade
Compliance	4	**9**	3	–	1	–	ComplianceRuleAssignment, Violation, ComplianceRule, Level

Domain	Specs	Operations	Alpha	Beta	Stable	Sunset	Largest APIs by operations
Accounting	4	**8**	2	2	–	–	PortfolioConfiguration, Valuations, CompositeMembership, AborLot
Clients	1	**7**	–	–	1	–	EnrichedCapitalFlow
Total	**54**	**301**	**24**	**6**	**23**	**1**	

Source: the 54 public specifications on PyPI[6]. Counts are mine, recomputed from the files. The core `aladdinsdk` package adds four utility APIs, not counted here. Each specification carries one stability label: alpha, beta, stable or sunset. The four columns count specifications by label. Domain names are BlackRock's own, taken from each specification's id, which begins `agraph.<domain>` for Aladdin Graph. Five of the 301 operations are marked for internal use.

The specifications also show how the APIs behave. They set out several controls. An order can be posted as a test (the `whatIf` setting). A compliance check runs by default (`runCompliance`). The response lists any compliance breaches with the order[6]. Compliance rule assignments carry a review state, such as draft, review required or approved[6]. Every request carries an application key and a credential, which is an OAuth 2.0 token, a client key, or a user name and password[6]. With OAuth, access is granted per API[6]. The specifications also name Aladdin user permissions, set by function, action and portfolio[6]. The public SDK's README says developers get their OAuth client ID and secret from Studio's screens[26].

What Studio is

Four BlackRock speakers describe Studio or its parts in recordings[1, 19, 38, 42]. Exhibit 6 lists them. BlackRock's own definition comes from the head of Studio engineering.

> "So we think about Aladdin today as a platform and Aladdin Studio is essentially the user experience that allows people to think of Aladdin as a platform. It exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do as a set of APIs [and] events. The Aladdin data cloud built on top of Snowflake takes all of that information that's generated through our analytics factory and inside of Aladdin and pushes that into Snowflake. And increasingly we're building a set of developer tools."
>
> Dave Woodhead, Head of Engineering for Aladdin Studio, Snowflake Data Cloud podcast, November 2025[1]

Exhibit 6. Four BlackRock executives describe Studio or its parts in recordings, and only Woodhead lists all three parts in one definition

Speaker, title as the recording gives it, and date	What they said	Parts they name
Kunal Khara, Managing Director and Global Head of Aladdin Product. Awards interview, early 2024	Named "the Aladdin studio estate" a 2024 focus. "More users are craving this ability to interact with our data, with their data, with reporting with dashboards on a programmatic basis"[42]	None by name. Programmatic access implies APIs
Richard Newman, General Manager, Aladdin Studio. Never Done podcast, January 2025	"Aladdin data cloud specifically comes in, which is part of Studio"; "those analytic APIs ... That's all part of the Studio umbrella"[19]	APIs, Data Cloud
Diwakar Goel, Global Head of Data, Aladdin. Pensions webinar, 2025	"every single transaction that happens should be available and accessible to you via an event, via an API"; "we actually want to give you a near real time data store"[38]	APIs, events, Data Cloud
Dave Woodhead, Managing Director and Head of Engineering for Aladdin Studio. Snowflake podcast, November 2025	"It exposes everything Aladdin knows how to do as a set of APIs [and] events. The Aladdin data cloud built on top of Snowflake ... And increasingly we're building a set of developer tools"[1]	APIs and events, Data Cloud, developer tools

Source: the four recordings cited[1, 19, 38, 42]. Quotations are verbatim. Three of the four transcripts (Khara, Goel and Woodhead) are machine-made, as marked in Sources. Goel does not use the name Studio.

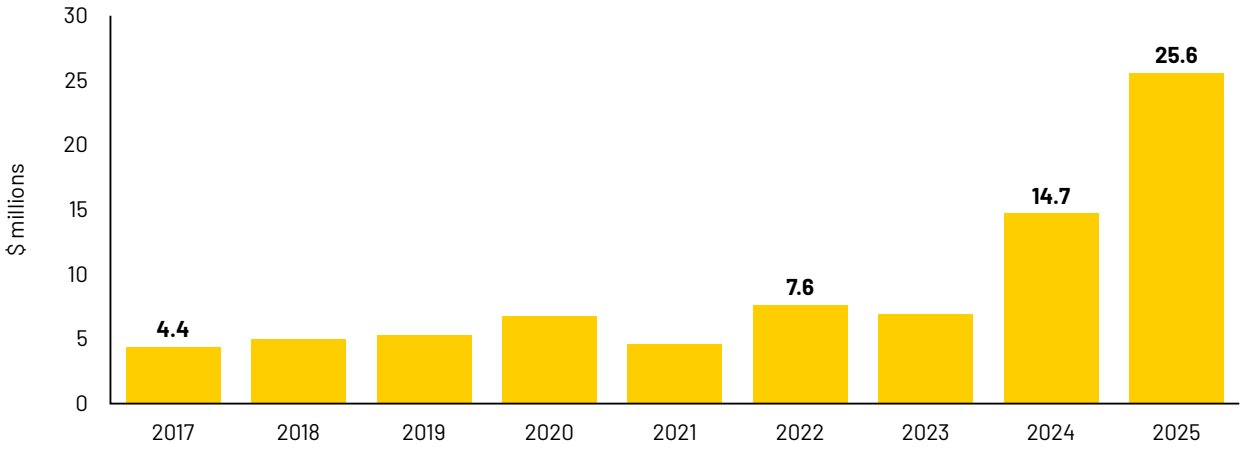
Khara, Newman, Goel and Woodhead describe ways for clients to reach Aladdin through code. Only Woodhead lists all three parts in one definition[1]. A 2026 job posting calls Studio Developer "Aladdin's extensibility layer"[43]. Speakers since 2024 describe Studio as APIs and data access. BlackRock can build Studio's positioning on that shared description.

Part 2

1. The public record of clients using Aladdin can serve as Studio's proof

BlackRock's Studio page names no client building on Studio[14], and a full-text search of SEC EDGAR finds no filing that mentions Studio[44]. Proof that clients use Aladdin, though, is public. The first kind of record is what clients say and file. In a BlackRock client video, Hans Georgeson, then chief executive of Royal London Asset Management, praises the Snowflake implementation in Royal London's Aladdin program[45]. JPMorgan Chase's proxy statements report payments to BlackRock for Aladdin in every year since 2017, reaching $25.6 million in 2025[46, 47]. Janus Henderson's 10-K says the firm chose in 2025 to move its investment management system to Aladdin[48].

Exhibit 7. JPMorgan Chase's payments for Aladdin rose from under $8 million a year to $25.6 million in 2025



Source: JPMorgan Chase proxy statements (DEF 14A) filed 2017 to 2026[46, 47]. The chart plots each payment in the year it was made. The proxies do not say which Aladdin services the payments cover. A 2016 trade press report says JPMorgan was connecting to Aladdin for its custody clients[49].

A second kind of record is code from a client's engineers. In December 2025 an engineer at a client firm submitted two changes to the open-source SDK[50]. Both help firms that send Aladdin calls through their own enterprise gateway[26]. A BlackRock Aladdin Studio engineer accepted both into the SDK[36, 51, 52]. Public buyers add a third kind of record: procurement notices.

Exhibit 8. BlackRock won the tenders of three public pension bodies

Buyer	Year	Outcome
UK Pension Protection Fund[53]	2025	BlackRock won both parts of the tender[53]
Nest (UK)[54]	2023	Nest chose BlackRock's Aladdin over six other bids[54, 55]
US Pension Benefit Guaranty Corporation[56]	2017 and 2023	BlackRock won an investment risk system contract both times[56, 57]. The records name BlackRock, not Aladdin

Source: UK Find a Tender[53, 54]; Nest[55]; USAspending.gov[56, 57].

None of this proof names Studio. It still backs a Studio pitch, because Studio is sold for building on Aladdin, and a buyer who builds on a platform wants to know that other institutions chose it and kept it. Firms whose filings or tenders already name BlackRock may be easier to name in public as Aladdin references.

> **What this finding suggests about direction.** A Studio case study that names the client can start with a client that builds with Studio.

2. BlackRock tells investors Aladdin is growing as a platform, but rarely names Studio

At its 2025 Investor Day, BlackRock estimated that API calls across BlackRock and Aladdin would grow 17x by 2030[11]. The slide counts calls across BlackRock and Aladdin together and does not say who makes them. BlackRock also tells investors it is "empowering clients with data and APIs"[12] and lists "Aladdin as a platform" among Aladdin's growth drivers[11]. No executive said "Studio" on any of the 27 earnings calls from the first quarter of 2020 to the third quarter of 2026[58]. Outside the calls, the only investor-facing mention I found is a single line on a 2023 Investor Day slide[59]. BlackRock's 10-K says technology services fees are generally set by the value of positions on the platform or at a fixed rate. It does not list API calls among its fee terms[12].

Exhibit 9. No BlackRock executive said "Studio" on any of 27 earnings calls, Q1 2020 to Q3 2026

Term	Mentions	Where it came up
Studio	**0**	**Never**
Data Cloud	2	Q3 2022[60] and Q4 2024[61]
API	1	Q4 2021: "clients are really looking to use both data and APIs"[62]
Copilot	1	Q4 2023: "investments in Aladdin AI copilots"[63]
AI agent or agentic	0	Never

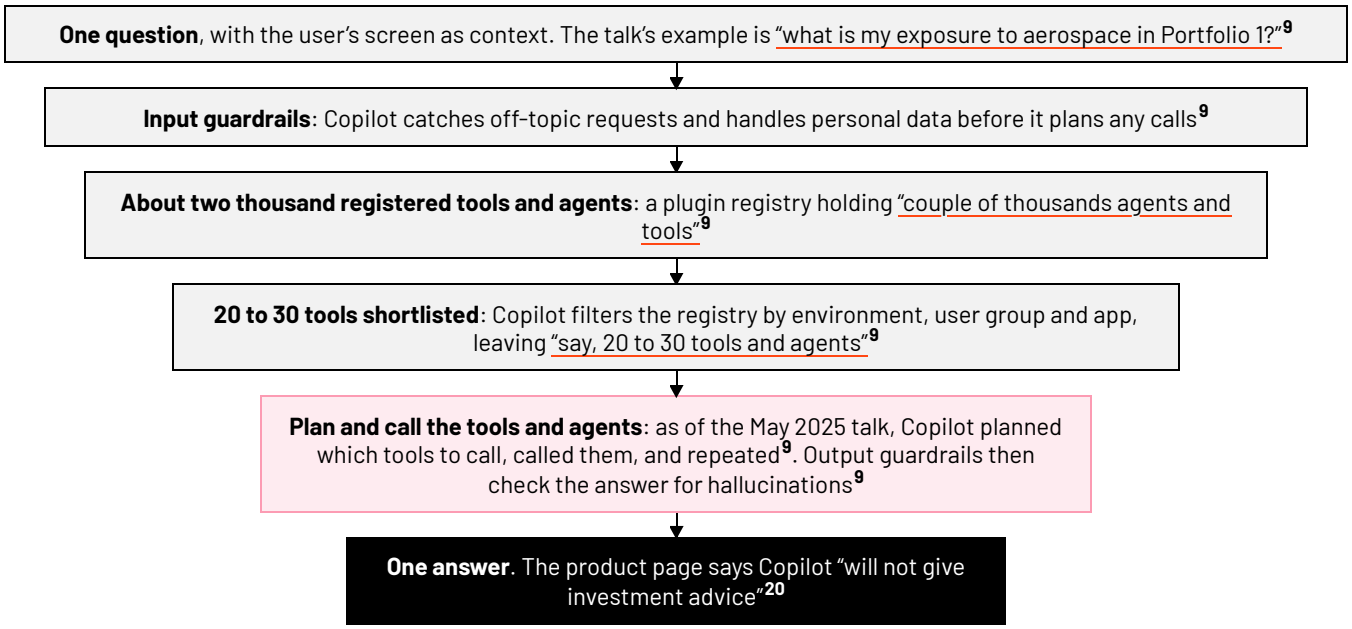
Source: third-party transcripts of BlackRock earnings calls, Q1 2020 to Q3 2026[58]. The tally is mine. Zeros mean the term appears in no transcript. The other counts are approximate.

What this finding suggests about direction. BlackRock could name Studio as the product behind "Aladdin as a platform"[11] when it speaks to investors.

3. Many providers let outside AI tools connect. Aladdin's own AI assistant works only inside Aladdin.

Aladdin Copilot, the AI inside the login, calls Aladdin's production APIs as tools. It draws on a registry of about two thousand tools and agents built by Aladdin's engineering teams[9]. A team can define a tool "mapping one-to-one to an existing Aladdin API already out in production"[9]. Some public APIs back BlackRock's own screens, such as Risk Radar[6]. Woodhead describes Studio as exposing "everything Aladdin knows how to do" as APIs and events[1]. The public specifications hold 301 operations[6]. Whether Copilot's tools include the public APIs is not public. Copilot draws on about two thousand tools and agents[9], so many of its tools likely sit on APIs clients cannot call. On BlackRock's podcast in November 2024, after Microsoft's Adrian Crockett said some clients may want BlackRock's plug-ins in their own copilots, BlackRock's Head of Product for AI said, "we are hearing that from our clients"[64].

Exhibit 10. Copilot answers a question by picking from about two thousand tools and agents, then calling tools, each mapped to a production Aladdin API, and agents



Source: Rosales and Valdez at LangChain Interrupt 2025[9]; the Copilot page[20]. The tool counts are the speakers' own estimates.

Exhibit 11 lists what the 11 providers I chose to compare have made public about AI access. Eight of the 11 offer outside AI tools a connector or an MCP (Model Context Protocol) server, a standard way for outside AI tools to connect. They are all six data and cloud providers, Bloomberg and Arcesium. Aladdin's AI, like SimCorp's and Clearwater's, works inside the platform. According to the public SDK's README, a licensed client's own programs call the APIs with credentials registered in Studio[26]. That would include a client's own AI tools. BlackRock has published no guide, MCP server or AI connector for them.

Exhibit 11. Eight of the 11 providers offer outside AI tools a connector or an MCP server. Aladdin's AI, like SimCorp's and Clearwater's, works inside the platform.

Provider	What is public	Source
System-of-record rivals		
SimCorp	SimCorp offers a portfolio management agent today. Agent Launchpad, announced in April 2026, is to let clients use prebuilt agents and build their own, with controlled access to SimCorp One data	SimCorp news[65]
Arcesium	Aquata's MCP server lets outside AI tools query data and build pipelines. Arcesium Intelligence, launched in May 2026, adds over 100 agents and a studio for clients to build their own	Arcesium press releases, Aquata MCP page and a reprint[7, 66, 67, 68]
Clearwater	Clearwater's CWAN GenAI, launched in November 2025, runs over 800 agents built by clients and Clearwater teams inside its platform	Clearwater press release[8]
Bloomberg	Bloomberg launched Enterprise MCP in September 2026, giving clients' AI agents access to its licensed Data License data	Bloomberg press release[69]
Data and cloud providers		
FactSet	FactSet has offered an MCP server for its data since December 2025	FactSet press release[3]
LSEG	LSEG has announced a collaboration with Anthropic and an MCP server. It had 90 customers connected to its MCP server by April 2026	LSEG press releases[2, 70]
MSCI	MSCI offers AI connectors in ChatGPT and Claude, starting with index data	MSCI press release[4]
S&P Global	S&P Global's AI Data Portal serves its data to any MCP-enabled AI application. It added Credit Ratings in September 2026	S&P Global press release[71]
Snowflake	Snowflake documents a managed MCP server for its Cortex AI tools and SQL	Snowflake documentation[5]
Databricks	Databricks documents managed MCP servers, some of them in beta	Databricks documentation[72]
Aladdin, for comparison		
Aladdin	**Copilot for clients, inside the platform. No published connector for outside AI tools.**	**Copilot page**[20]

Source: the press releases, documentation and product pages in the Source column, as of October 2026. State Street is not listed because I found no AI feature it has released to clients.

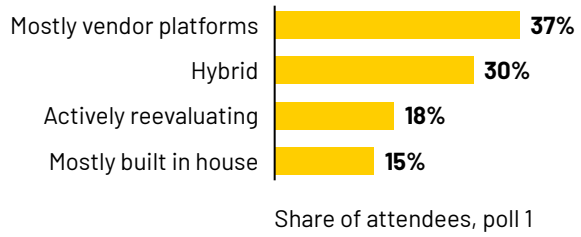
What this finding suggests about direction. BlackRock could describe how Copilot's tools are registered, permissioned and tested[9].

4. At BlackRock's own webinar, two thirds of attendees said they run vendor or hybrid platforms

BlackRock ran a Build vs. Buy webinar for asset managers and polled the attendees. The first poll asked where firms sit today. Exhibit 12 shows the answers[10]. The second poll asked what is driving the build-or-buy decision. "AI and data demands" led at 42 percent[10].

Exhibit 12. Two thirds of webinar attendees run mostly vendor or hybrid platforms

Where firms sit today



Source: Build vs. Buy webinar, poll 1[10]. Respondents to a BlackRock webinar. Number not given.

> "What's the API suite that you have? Are you using connectors to Snowflake or to Databricks? And I think that that part of the RFP has become much more prominent."
>
> Clark Schafer, Partner, Alpha FMC, on the Build vs. Buy webinar[10]

Alisha Sewdass, BlackRock's Head of Aladdin Solutions Engineering, Americas, gave BlackRock's side on the same webinar. She said clients are making a "move to more of a modular approach"[10]. They also want "very, very robust APIs that manage the end to end life cycle of a transaction"[10]. Those APIs let clients build "their secret sauce rebalancing tools" on top[10]. On AI, she said, "you need that system of record that underpins anything that AI is built upon." She called a "really defined system of work", with workflows governed by operational controls, the other layer that is "almost equally important"[10].

Rivals sell the same model, a core platform with the client's own builds on top. Pictet chose SimCorp One in May 2026 and plans to connect its own tools to it by API[73].

> **What this finding suggests about direction.** Buyers now ask in RFPs whether they can build on the platform. Studio is BlackRock's answer to that question, so it could lead the API section of a response.

Part 3

Directions to explore

BlackRock could present Studio as the place where clients' own AI tools use the tools Copilot uses, acting for each user under that user's Aladdin permissions. BlackRock has made related claims. Its speakers have said that the system of record underpins anything built with AI[10], and that the data model is being structured for agentic use[74]. I have not seen BlackRock describe Studio this way.

SimCorp[65], Clearwater[8] and Arcesium[67, 68] have announced AI agents or AI platforms. What BlackRock can show is scale in production: Copilot runs across about 100 applications on about two thousand registered tools and agents[9].

Some controls sit inside Aladdin's services and apply to every caller. The specifications tie operations to Aladdin user permissions, set by function, action and portfolio. Posting an order runs a compliance check by default. The caller can skip that check with the same Order:write scope it uses to post. Whether an Aladdin permission restricts skipping the check is not public. In Aladdin's PM and trader split, a portfolio manager authorizes an order before the trader's order is created, and the public order API has no call to authorize one[6].

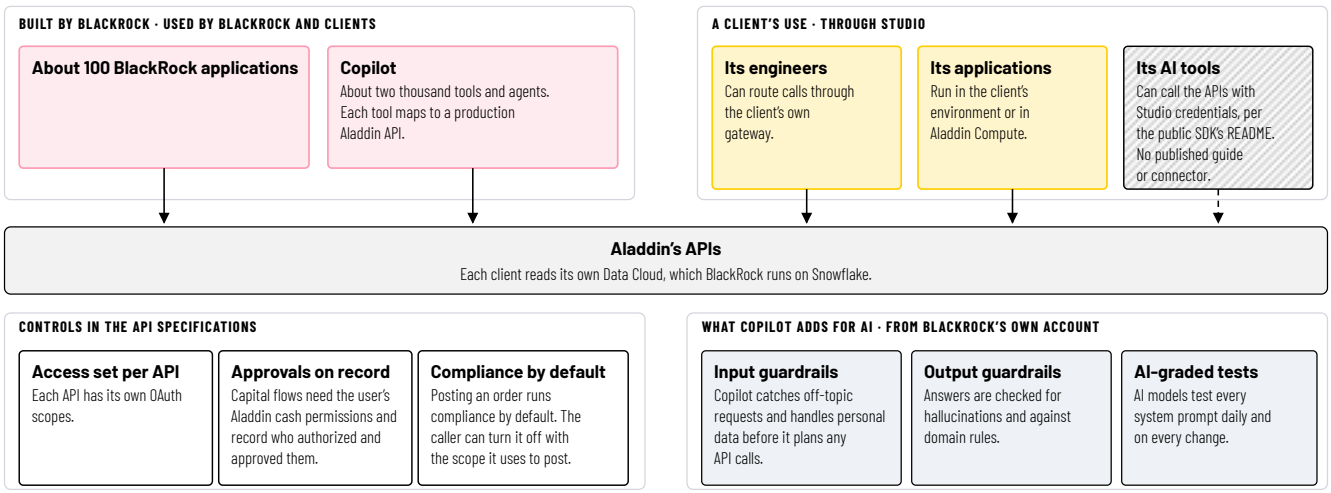
Other controls sit where a caller connects. Copilot applies its registry rules by environment, user group and app as it picks tools[9]. Studio clients connect with an application key and a credential, such as an OAuth token scoped to each API[6]. According to the public SDK's README, a licensed client's own programs call the APIs with credentials registered in Studio[26]. That would include a client's own AI tools. A tool that signs in for a user carries that user's permissions. A tool that signs in as an application carries the application's permissions.

Copilot's own guardrails, planning and AI-graded tests run inside Copilot[9]. A client's own AI model would not get these. A route for clients' AI tools would need BlackRock to apply Copilot's registry rules where those tools connect, and to offer checks of its own in place of Copilot's guardrails. One such route would be an MCP server onto Copilot's registry, or an agent protocol such as A2A. That is my inference. Copilot's team has said it is evaluating A2A and LangChain's agent protocol[9].

At BlackRock's webinar, buyers named AI and data demands as the top reason to rethink what to build and what to buy[10]. The poll did not ask whether clients want AI tools that act on Aladdin. BlackRock sizes Aladdin's addressable market at more than $20 billion and projects API calls across BlackRock and Aladdin to grow 17x by 2030[11]. My inference is that clients' AI tools, acting through Studio, could become a large source of those calls. How many clients run their own AI tools is not public.

Three things would have to be true for this direction to hold. Clients would have to want Aladdin's tools inside their own AI tools, and later want those tools to act. Their risk teams and regulators would have to accept it, with a portfolio manager authorizing each order. And BlackRock would have to offer tools it built to AI models it did not build.

Exhibit 13. BlackRock's apps, Copilot and client code run on Aladdin's APIs



■ Solid boxes are in the public record. The hatched box marks a use no public source shows yet: a client's AI tool calling the APIs. The client tiles rest on the public SDK and its README, which may not match the version clients use. The left-hand controls apply to calls through the APIs. Data Cloud, storage and the Data eXchange have their own access controls. The right-hand controls are Copilot's own and stay inside Copilot. Sources: Rosales and Valdez[9], the Studio page[14], the Data Cloud launch release[31], the Copilot page[20], two SDK pull requests[51, 52], the public SDK's README[26], Aladdin's public API specifications[6], the Data Cloud page[18], Woodhead[1] and Fivetran[24].

Exhibit 14. Four pieces of marketing work to explore, in the order I would start them

	The work	What it is	How to know it worked
1	**An answer for RFPs**	A ready answer to "what APIs do you have, and can we connect to them". It lists the APIs by area and marks which are stable. It explains permissions and how a client routes calls through its own gateway. It covers the Snowflake connection for Data Cloud, and how a client's own AI tools can call the APIs today.	Time to answer the API section of an RFP. Number of RFPs in which buyers score Studio. How many of those are won.
2	**A worked example: an AI-proposed rebalance**	A page and a demo. In the demo, the client's AI tool proposes a rebalance and posts it as what-if orders with compliance on. A portfolio manager would then authorize the orders before a trader works them[6]. BlackRock says clients can build their own rebalancing tools on Aladdin's APIs[10].	Meetings that open on this example; pipeline tagged to it; API calls from clients who build it
3	**One client willing to be named**	One named client that builds with Studio.	Named clients sales can cite; deals in which one is cited
4	**How a client's AI tools act on Aladdin**	Once BlackRock decides to offer it: a page on how a client's AI tools could use the tools Copilot uses, for each user under that user's Aladdin permissions, with a portfolio manager authorizing each order before it trades.	Publication of the page. A clear answer on AI connections in RFPs and deal reviews. API calls from client AI tools.

Part 4

What I could not see

I read everything here from outside, with no client login. So this document cannot confirm what clients see. Exhibit 15 follows a prospect's engineer through six steps. I could read the pages, unpack the specifications and read the SDK's code. I could not run anything, test what a client receives, or open the catalog and the API guides. Where this document describes the catalog, the guides or what a client receives, it relies on what sources say.

Exhibit 15. At each step, what is public today and what opens only after qualification or becoming a client

Step	Public today	After qualification or becoming a client	Receipt
Hear	Podcasts, video series and webinar replays on BlackRock's site	The invitation-only Aladdin Client Forum and the Solutions Engineering team	the Never Done podcast[75], the Big Little Questions video series[76], webinar replay[10], Client Forum page[77], Solutions Engineering job posting[78]
Read	The Studio page and the APIs page, which promises "dozens of Aladdin APIs"	The Developer Portal and the API framework guides	Studio page[14], APIs page[27], developer portal[6, 35], job posting[39]
See the catalog	The 54 specifications. Public, but only by unpacking the packages	The API catalog and the Data Dictionary	asdk_plugin packages[6], plugin builder[79], APIs page[27], developer portal[35]
Try	Nothing to run: no public sandbox or trial is offered	Per the public SDK's README: Studio Compute (hosted Python), API credentials registered in Studio, and the client's Aladdin address	SDK README[26]
Build	The public, open-source SDK on GitHub and PyPI, with a detailed README, sample code and demo notebooks. The plugin builder. Merged code changes from outside developers.	A client host and credentials, which the public SDK needs for every call	SDK README[26], PyPI history[80], plugin builder[79], SDK change for enterprise gateways[51], SDK change for extra HTTP headers[52]
Get help	No public support channel.	Jupyter notebooks and code samples from the API guides	Studio page[14], APIs page[27]

Source: the pages and repositories in the Receipt column, read with no account or login, October 2026.

The SDK is the one piece of Studio a prospect can install before any conversation[26]. The public version may not match the one clients use.

Exhibit 16. Snowflake and Databricks are self-serve. Most others, Studio included, open fully only to clients.

2: Fully public or self-serve 1: Partial or after sign-up or approval 0: Not reachable without a client relationship

Platform	Public docs	API catalog	Trial or sandbox	First API call without a contract	Sample code	Community or marketplace	AI connector	Call to action
Investment platforms								
Bloomberg	2	0	1	0	2	1	2	1
Aladdin Studio	**1**	**1**	**0**	**0**	**2**	**1**	**0**	**0**
State Street	1	0	0	0	1	1	0	1
Arcesium	0	0	1	1	0	1	2	1
SimCorp	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0
Clearwater	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	0
Data and cloud platforms								
Snowflake	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2
Databricks	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2
LSEG	1	2	1	1	2	2	2	1
FactSet	2	2	1	0	2	1	2	1
MSCI	1	2	0	0	2	1	2	1

Except in the AI connector column, 0 means not reachable without a client relationship. The AI connector column scores whether a connector exists. Most connectors are for licensed clients. For the AI connector score: 2 means a connector that outside AI tools can use, such as an MCP server. 1 means one announced or in limited release. 0 means none, or an assistant that works only inside the vendor's own platform. For the Call to action score: 2 means a developer can sign up and start alone, 1 a trial or access request, and 0 sales contact only.

Source: my test of each platform's public pages[2, 4, 5, 6, 8, 14, 26, 27, 65, 66, 67, 69, 72, 81, 82, 83, 84, 85, 86, 87, 88, 89, 90, 91, 92, 93, 94, 95, 96], no accounts or payments, October 8 to 20, 2026. Bloomberg and Clearwater may score lower than they deserve, because some of their pages blocked automated access.

Exhibit 16 puts Studio beside five investment platforms that compete with Aladdin and five data and cloud platforms, included as benchmarks for developer access. It scores each from 0 to 2 on eight things a developer with no client relationship can reach. The scores follow how each vendor sells. Investment platforms score low because a first API call needs a client relationship. Arcesium is the exception, with a 30-day trial of its Aquata data platform[88]. Studio scores in line with them, but trails Bloomberg and Arcesium on AI connectors (0 against 2). Snowflake and Databricks sell to developers directly and score highest.

About this document

This is an independent analysis compiled from public sources: BlackRock's pages, filings, job postings and recordings, public code on GitHub and PyPI, and other vendors' pages and trade press. BlackRock did not produce, review or endorse this analysis. Facts are as of October 19, 2026, unless an exhibit or a source entry gives another date.

AI agents pulled the pages, unpacked the packages, transcribed the recordings that had no published transcript or captions, and drafted the text. I checked each claim against the document or recording it cites.

Underlined text links to the document behind each fact. Superscripts point to the Sources section, which follows this page and gives each source's grade (P, S or T), title, publisher or speaker, and date where known.

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Sources

Sources are numbered in the order they are first cited. The letter after each number gives its grade. P is a primary document. S is a BlackRock speaker on the record, with name and title as the recording gives them. T is a third-party report. For recordings, each entry gives the minute and second at which each quoted passage begins. "Machine transcription" means speech-to-text software run locally on the downloaded audio. "Auto-captions" means YouTube's captions. Both can mishear names and jargon. Inside quotations, the only correction made was to the spelling of proper names the captions got wrong.

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